

Day	Creation: Genesis 1		Re-Creation: Genesis 8-9	
Second Day	1:6–8	• Separation of the waters above and the waters below	8:2b	• And the springs of the deep and the windows of the heavens were closed
Third Day	1:9	• Water gathered into one place and the dry ground appeared • Vegetation comes out of the ground	8:3–5, 11	• Waters return from the land and the tops of the mountains appeared • Dove returns with fresh olive branch
Fourth Day	1:14-19	• Sun and moon appointed to rule the boundaries of morning and evening	8:11	• Dove returns at time of evening
Fifth Day	1:20	• Let birds fly above the earth against the face of the sky dome	8:12	• Dove leaves the ark to return to the sky and land
Sixth Day	1:24	• Creation of living creatures, livestock, creepers on the ground	8:17	• Animals leave the ark, living creatures, livestock, creepers on the ground
	1:26	• Human is the image of God	9:6	• Human is the image of God
	1:29	• “There will be food for you”	9:3	• “There will be food for you”
Seventh Day	2:1-3	• “God rested” (<i>shabbat</i>) • “God blessed”	8:4, 22 9:1	• The ark “rested” (<i>nuakh</i>) • God “blessed” • The seasons “will not rest” (<i>shabbat</i>)
Genesis 8-9 Re-Creation. Adapted from Berman, Joshua (2017). <i>Inconsistency in the Torah</i> . Oxford University Press. By BibleProject for Classroom: Noah to Abraham (2020).				

The Flood Waters Recede from the Land: Translation and Literary Design of Genesis 8:2-5

The recession of the flood waters is described as the inversion of the flood’s beginning.

- a ² And **they were closed**,
 b the **fountains of the deep**
 b' and **the windows of the skies**,
 a **and it was restrained**,
 b' the rain **from the skies**.
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- a ³ And **the waters turned back** from upon the land,
 b going back and **the waters decreased**
 c at the end of one hundred and fifty days,
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- a ⁴ and **the ark rested**,
 b in the seventh month,
 b' on the seventeenth day of the month,
 a' **upon the mountains of Ararat**.
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- a ⁵ And **the waters were going and decreasing**
 b until the tenth month;
 b' in the tenth month,
 b'' on the first day of the month,
 a **the heads of the mountains** became visible.

Genesis 8:2-5. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Noah to Abraham (2020).

The Flood Reversed

This description is designed to precisely reverse the vocabulary and narrative movement of the waters' rising in Genesis 7:17-20.

Genesis 8:2-5	Genesis 7:11-12, 17-20
² And they were closed, the fountains of the deep and the windows of the skies, and it was restrained, the rain from the skies.	¹¹ And they split open, the fountains of the great deep burst open, and the windows of the skies were opened. ¹² And there was rain upon the land
³ And the waters turned back from upon the land, going back and the waters decreased	¹⁷ And the flood was forty days upon the land, and the waters were great
<i>The Flood Waters Recede From the Land.</i> Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Noah to Abraham (2020).	

Genesis 8:2-5	Genesis 7:11-12, 17-20
at the end of one hundred and fifty days,	and they lifted up the ark, and it rose up over the land.
⁴ and the ark rested, in the seventh month, on the seventeenth day of the month, upon the mountains of Ararat.	¹⁸ And the waters were mighty, and they were very great upon the land, and the ark went on the face of the waters.
⁵ And the waters were going and decreasing until the tenth month; in the tenth month, on the first day of the month, the heads of the mountains became visible.	¹⁹ And the waters were mighty, very very much, upon the land, and they covered all the high mountains which are under the skies, ²⁰ fifteen cubits above, the waters were mighty, and they covered the mountains.
<i>The Flood Waters Recede From the Land.</i> Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Noah to Abraham (2020).	

- The waters above and below were released, later they are closed.
- The ark was lifted and rose up high. Then the ark rests and touches down.
- The waters were great and increased over the land. The waters recede and turn back.
- The waters covered the mountains. The heads of the mountains are revealed.

Mount Ararat

Notice that the narrator doesn't say which particular mountain the ark rested upon. The narrator simply says that it came to rest in "the mountains of Ararat."

The word "Ararat" (Heb. אֲרָרָט) is derived from Akkadian *Urartu*, and it refers to the region that today is on the far eastern border of Turkey, near Armenia. It's a highland hill country north of Mesopotamia in between Lake Van and the Caspian Sea. There are a number of high peaks that tower above the horizon.



Serouj Ourishian (2016). [Wikipedia](#)

Interestingly, in other Mesopotamian flood stories like the Epic of Gilgamesh, Utnapishtim's ark rests on "Mount Nimush" in the Zagros mountains on the eastern border of today's Iran and Iraq (some 400 miles from Mount Ararat). However, in Berossus' account, he names the region similar to the biblical account, in the mountains of Armenia. For more information, see John Day's "The Flood and the Ten Antediluvian Figures in Berossus and in the Priestly Source in Genesis" (Day, 2011. 65-67.).

Notice that the name Ararat forms an elaborate wordplay on Noah's birth story in Genesis 5:29. The Ararat wordplay relates to what Noah will do on this mountain when he gets out of the boat.

Noah's Naming

Genesis 5:28-29 NASB*

²⁸ And Lemek lived one hundred and eighty-two years, and he caused the birth of a son.

²⁹ And he called his name "Noah (נח)," saying,

"This one will give us **comfort (נחם)** from our work and from the toil of our hands from **the ground (האדמה)**) which the LORD has **cursed (אררה)**."

*Key Words Adapted by Teacher

Post-Flood Connections

Genesis 8:4 NASB*

and the ark **rested (נוח)** in the mountain of **Ararat (אררט)**

*Key Words Adapted by Teacher

Genesis 8:18-21 Instuctor's Translation

¹⁸ Noah went out from the ark ... ²⁰ And he built an altar to Yahweh and he caused an offering to go up on the altar, ²¹ and Yahweh smelled the **restful smell (ניחוח)** and Yahweh said to his heart, "I will never again curse (קלל) **the ground (האדמה)** on account of humanity."

Noah's name, rest (*noakh*), alludes to his destiny, which is to bring comfort (*nakhham*) to the ground that God has cursed (*'erarah*). So Noah's ark rests (נֹחַ) in the mountains of "carse" (*'ararat*) and offers a sacrificial smell (*nikhoakh*), and God says he won't curse the ground anymore.

In the Seventh Month, on the 17th Day

Noah's time on the ark has been coordinated with Israel's liturgical calendar that appears much later in the Torah (Lev. 23). The seventh month is the Fall new year celebration, and the 17th day is right in the middle of the festival of *Sukkot*/Tabernacles.

Given the importance of the ark as a proto-temple, this cannot be without significance: The ark, as a proto-tabernacle, goes through the chaos waters and comes to rest on a cosmic mountain at the same time of the year when the Israelites will later live in their micro-tabernacles during the feast of *Sukkot* to recall their journey through the desert on their way to the promised land.

Recall how in Genesis 1:2 the chaos waters and the desert are the two primary images of a non-ordered realm.

Noah, the Birds, and the Drying Land: Translation and Literary Design of Genesis 8:6-14

- a 6 And it came about at the end of forty days,
b and Noah opened the window of the ark which he had made;
7 and he sent out a raven,
and it flew here and there until the waters were dried up from upon the land.

- A
a 8 And he sent out a dove from him,
b to see if the waters were abated from the face of the ground;
c 9 and the dove found no place of rest (מנוח) for the sole of its foot,
c' and it returned to him into the ark,
b' because the waters were on the surface of all the land.
a' And he sent out his hand and took it,
a' and he brought it into the ark to himself.

- B
10 And he waited yet another seven days;
and again he sent out the dove from the ark.
11 And the dove came to him at the time of evening,
and behold, in its mouth was an olive leaf, freshly picked,
and Noah knew that the waters were abated from upon the land.